

Genesis 1:3 - Hebrew Handwriting & Reading Practice

Learn the word, say every letter name, notice what each mark does, then write it.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי אוֹר וַיְהִי־אוֹר:

Pronunciation: va-YO-mer eh-lo-HEEM yeh-HEE OR va-yeh-HEE OR.

Meaning: And God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light.

Word order

#	Hebrew	Transliteration	Pronunciation	Meaning
1	וַיֹּאמֶר	vayomer	va-YO-mer	and He said
2	אֱלֹהִים	Elohim	eh-lo-HEEM	God
3	יְהִי	yehi	yeh-HEE	let there be / let it be
4	אוֹר	or	OR	light
5	וַיְהִי־אוֹר	vayehi-or	va-yeh-HEE OR	and there was light

Genesis 1:3 - Word / Phrase 1

וַיֹּאמֶר

Transliteration	vayomer
Pronunciation	va-YO-mer
Meaning	and He said
From / dictionary form	אָמַר amar - to say

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
וּ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יִ	Yod	y / helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound. Dagesh strengthens/doubles this consonant.
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.
מְ	Mem	m	Segol gives the 'eh' sound.
ר	Resh	r	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:3 - Word / Phrase 2

אלהים

Transliteration	Elohim
Pronunciation	eh-lo-HEEM
Meaning	God
From / dictionary form	אלהים Elohim - God

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Hatef Segol gives a quick 'eh' sound.
ל	Lamed	l	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ה	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:3 - Word / Phrase 3

יְהִי

Transliteration	yehi
Pronunciation	yeh-HEE
Meaning	let there be / let it be
From / dictionary form	הָיָה hayah - to be / become

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Sheva is very short or silent here.
הִ	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:3 - Word / Phrase 4

אור

Transliteration	or		
Pronunciation	OR		
Meaning	light		
From / dictionary form	אור	or - light	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.
י	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ר	Resh	r	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:3 - Word / Phrase 5

וַיְהִי־אֹר

Transliteration	vayehi-or
Pronunciation	va-yeh-HEE OR
Meaning	and there was light
From / dictionary form	הָיָה hayah - to be / become

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
וּ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Sheva is very short or silent here.
הֶ	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
—	Maqaf	no sound	Maqaf joins the words; it has no sound.
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.
וֹ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ר	Resh	r	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:3 - Put It All Together

Start at the RIGHT edge and move LEFT. Say the letter names and notice the vowel marks as you write.

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי אוֹר וַיְהִי־אוֹר:

Pronunciation: va-YO-mer eh-lo-HEEM yeh-HEE OR va-yeh-HEE OR.

Meaning: And God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light.

Copy the complete verse:

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